Mehfil-e-Zan

Gather. Grow. Glow.

MARKETING AND BRAND GUIDELINES

One warm, honest voice across every post, poster and conversation

Document ID	MEZ-GDL-001 (assumed)
Document title	Marketing and Brand Guidelines
Version	1.0
Effective date	01 November 2026 (assumed)
Last review date	Not yet reviewed (first issue)
Next review date	01 November 2027
Document owner	HR / Sales / Marketing Manager
Approval authority	CEO and Owner
Status	Draft for approval
Applies to	All employees, instructors, contractors, designers and partners who create or share content, run campaigns or reply to the public for Mehfil-e-Zan

Student project note: *This document is a student project deliverable. Targets, budgets, response times and schedules are business assumptions. Advertising, consumer protection, copyright, data protection and platform rules must be checked for Pakistan and Sindh, and reviewed by a qualified adviser, before a real business adopts these guidelines.*

1. Purpose and Scope

1.1 Purpose

Mehfil-e-Zan is a place of trust. How we look and sound online and in print must feel the same as how we treat guests inside: warm, calm, respectful and true. These guidelines explain how we present ourselves consistently and ethically, and how we find new guests without pressure or exaggeration.

1.2 Scope

They cover audience, positioning, brand voice, logo and colours, social media, content planning, advertising and campaigns, lead generation, KPIs, testimonials and reviews, truthful claims and reputation management. Client communication is in MEZ-SOP-008. Guest privacy and photos are in MEZ-SOP-002.

1.3 Business assumptions

- Mehfil-e-Zan is a women-only cafe and community space in Gulshan-e-Iqbal, Karachi, open daily from 10:00 AM to 10:00 PM, with 40 seats.
- Offers: cafe, reading and work corner, weekly events and workshops, mothers' meetups, private bookings, and memberships (Day Pass Rs. 500, Mehfil Pass Rs. 3,000 a month, Work & Sip Rs. 6,000 a month).
- Main channels: Instagram, Facebook, WhatsApp Business, Google Business Profile, the website, posters and community groups.
- The yearly marketing budget is set by the CEO and Finance Director (MEZ-SOP-009).

1.4 Related documents

Document ID	Title	Link to these guidelines
MEZ-SOP-002	Security Measures SOP	Photo consent, privacy
MEZ-SOP-007	Professional Communication Ethics SOP	Tone, social media conduct
MEZ-SOP-008	Client Communication and Engagement Ethics SOP	Truthful pricing, complaints
MEZ-SOP-009	Finance and Expense Management SOP	Marketing spend approvals
MEZ-POL-001	IT Rules and Regulations Policy	Account access, data protection
MEZ-PLN-002	Sales Targets and Performance Plan	Lead handling, targets
MEZ-FRM-043 to 047	Marketing forms (Annexes A to E)	Calendar, campaign plan, consents, response log

Note: *Document and form numbers are assumed and should be matched to the master Document Register.*

2. Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Responsibilities under these guidelines
Owner and CEO	Approve brand changes, yearly budget, major campaigns and public statements in a crisis.
HR / Sales / Marketing Manager	Owns these guidelines. Approves the content calendar, campaigns, claims and influencer or partner agreements. Handles serious reputation issues.
Marketing Executive	Creates and posts content, runs ads, monitors channels, replies to comments and messages, tracks KPIs and keeps the content library.
Sales Executive	Follows up leads, shares real offers and prices, collects testimonials with consent.
Finance Director	Approves ad spend within limits and checks that offers and discounts are priced correctly.
Security & Safety Manager	Checks that photos and videos respect privacy rules before publishing. Advises on event safety messages.
IT Manager	Manages social media and website access, two-step verification and backups.
Documentation & Compliance Coordinator	Keeps consent forms, claim evidence and campaign records. Checks compliance.
All employees	Represent the brand with care. Do not speak for Mehfil-e-Zan in public without approval.

3. Target Audience and Positioning

3.1 Who we serve

Audience	What she needs	What we offer	Best channels
Students	A quiet, safe, affordable place to study and meet friends	Day Pass, WiFi, reading corner, study-friendly tables	Instagram, university groups
Working women	A calm break, a place for meetings and networking	Work & Sip, coffee and light meals, workshops	Instagram, LinkedIn, WhatsApp
Mothers' groups	Safe, kid-friendly meetups and company	Mothers' Meetups, private bookings	Facebook groups, WhatsApp, word of mouth
Homemakers	Social time, hobbies and skills	Book club, mehndi, baking, calligraphy	Facebook, WhatsApp, posters
Freelancers	A professional space with WiFi, power and community	Mehfil Pass, Work & Sip, freelancing workshops	Instagram, LinkedIn, freelancer groups

3.2 Positioning

Positioning statement: For women in Karachi who want a safe, welcoming place to relax, work and learn, Mehfil-e-Zan is the women-only cafe and community space where a cup of chai becomes a circle of

support. Unlike an ordinary cafe, we combine food, workshops, a work corner and a membership network under one roof, in a space that respects privacy.

Brand pillar	What we say and show
Safe and private	Women-only staff and guests. Photos only with consent. Calm, respectful atmosphere.
Warm and cultural	Chai, courtyard feeling, books, mehndi patterns. Proudly Pakistani.
Useful	A place to learn, earn and connect: workshops, work corner and a community network.
Fair and welcoming	Clear prices, comfortable seats for hours, no pressure to buy.

Tagline: Gather. Grow. Glow. **Vision:** To be Karachi's most trusted space where women gather, grow and glow.

4. Brand Voice

We are	We are not	Example
Warm and friendly	Cold or corporate	"Come in, the chai is hot and your seat is ready."
Clear and simple	Full of jargon or hype	"The book club meets every Thursday at 5 PM."
Respectful and calm	Loud, pushy or shaming	"Take your time. Stay as long as you like."
Honest	Exaggerated or misleading	"We have 40 seats. Please book for groups."
Proudly local	Copying foreign trends blindly	An occasional Urdu word: mehfil, chai, baithak

- Write in short sentences. Use English or simple Urdu (Roman or Nastaliq). Mix with care: one language per sentence where possible.
- Never mock, shame or compare women's looks, bodies, religion, class, marriage or motherhood.
- Emojis: a few warm ones ( ) are fine. No more than three per post.
- No jokes about stereotypes, politics or religion. Stay out of political debates.

5. Logo and Colour Usage

5.1 Logo

The logo is a circle containing a teacup, with steam shaped like flower petals. The name Mehfil-e-Zan appears beside or below it.

Rule	Detail
Clear space	Keep empty space around the logo equal to the height of the teacup handle.
Minimum size	24 mm wide in print and 80 px wide on screen.

Rule	Detail
Backgrounds	Use on cream or white, or on sage green or dark brown with a light version. Check contrast.
Do not	Stretch, rotate, recolour, add shadows or outlines, put on busy photos, or redraw it.
Files	Master files are kept by the Marketing Executive in the brand folder. Use only these files.

5.2 Colours

Colour	Hex	Use
Sage green (main)	#9CAF88	Main brand colour: panels, borders, section backgrounds, icons
Terracotta	#C66B4E	Buttons, links, highlights and accents
Cream	#F7F0E3	Page and poster backgrounds
Dark brown	#3E2C23	Body text and logos on light backgrounds
Deep sage and deep terracotta	#5E7350 and #B5573B	Headings and small text on cream, for better readability (used in our documents)

Use mostly cream and sage, with terracotta for one clear action per page. Dark text must always have strong contrast against its background.

5.3 Fonts and patterns

- **Cormorant Garamond** for headings. **Lato** for body text. **Noto Nastaliq Urdu** for the Urdu name and Urdu text.
- Use subtle mehndi or floral line patterns as dividers or soft backgrounds. They should never cover text.
- Photos should be warm, natural and real. Avoid heavy filters and stock images of people who are not our guests.

6. Social Media Rules

6.1 Accounts and access

- Only business accounts are used: Instagram, Facebook, WhatsApp Business and Google Business Profile. Staff do not post from personal accounts as the business.
- Logins are held by the IT Manager. Two-step verification is on. Passwords are not shared in chats. Access is removed when someone leaves.

6.2 Posting rules

Do	Do not
Post real photos of the space, food, books, events and team	Show a guest’s face or child without written consent (Annex C)

Do	Do not
Credit instructors and partners, with their permission	Use music, images or text we do not have the right to use
Give correct prices, dates and times	Announce events before they are confirmed
Reply to messages politely and on time	Argue, mock or reply in anger in public
Share community news that fits our values	Share rumours, political content or unverified claims
Mark paid partnerships clearly	Hide that a post is sponsored or a gift was received

6.3 Staff and personal accounts

Staff may share our posts. They must not post photos of guests, the inside of washrooms or the prayer area, or any private details. They must not speak for the business or criticise it publicly. Concerns go through the grievance process in MEZ-POL-002.

7. Content Calendar

The Marketing Executive plans content every month on Annex A and the HR / Sales / Marketing Manager approves it by the 25th of the previous month.

Day	Theme (assumed)	Example content
Monday	Motivation and the week ahead	Weekly events list, a calm start quote
Tuesday	Menu spotlight	Karak chai, parathas, a new dessert
Wednesday	Learn and grow	Workshop teaser, instructor introduction
Thursday	Community	Book club, member story (with consent)
Friday	Behind the scenes	Our team, baking, setting up the corner
Saturday	Event recap	Photos from events (with consent), thank you
Sunday	Offers and membership	Pass reminders and honest offers

- Target: 4 posts and 3 stories a week on Instagram, 3 posts a week on Facebook (assumed).
- Fixed dates: Ramadan and Eid, Pakistan Day, International Women's Day and local festivals are planned early with sensitive, respectful content.
- Every post is checked for facts, spelling, privacy and tone by a second person before it goes live.

8. Advertising and Campaign Planning

8.1 Campaign steps

1. **Goal.** One clear goal, for example 40 new Mehfil Pass members in a month.
2. **Plan.** Complete Annex B: audience, message, offer, channels, dates, budget, KPIs and risks.
3. **Approve.** HR / Sales / Marketing Manager approves the plan. The Finance Director approves the budget (MEZ-SOP-009).

4. **Create and check.** Content is checked against Section 12 (truthful claims) and privacy rules.
5. **Launch and monitor.** Daily check of results and comments for the first week.
6. **Review.** A short report within 7 days of the end: results, cost per lead, lessons.

8.2 Channels and budget (assumed)

Channel	Use	Share of budget
Instagram and Facebook ads	Local targeting (Gulshan, nearby areas), events, membership	40%
Partnerships and community	Universities, women's groups, local women creators	25%
Printed material	Posters, flyers, menu cards in nearby offices and campuses	15%
Events and trial days	Open mornings, free tasting, referral offers	15%
Tools and content	Photography, design tools, scheduling	5%

8.3 Advertising rules

- Offers must state price, dates, conditions and limits. No hidden charges.
- Do not use fear, guilt or shame to sell. Do not target children.
- Do not use competitors' names or logos in a negative way.
- Influencers and local creators sign a short agreement that states what they will say, how they must disclose the partnership and that they must not make false claims.
- Keep a copy of every ad and campaign in the campaign folder.

9. Lead Generation Strategy

Stage	Action	Owner
Attract	Useful posts, events, Google Business Profile, local SEO, posters, campus and community partnerships	Marketing Executive
Capture	WhatsApp click-to-chat, website form, event sign-up, QR codes, referral cards. Ask for consent to contact.	Marketing and Sales Executives
Reply	Reply in line with the response times in MEZ-SOP-008. Share honest information and an invitation to visit.	Sales Executive
Convert	Offer a visit, trial Day Pass or workshop seat. Explain the passes simply.	Sales Executive
Keep	Welcome message, feedback request, member events, referral thanks	Sales and Marketing Executives

- Ideas: first workshop at a student price, bring-a-friend week, referral reward of a free chai, partner discounts for campus societies, "Mothers' Morning" open days.
- Contact details are used only for the purpose the person agreed. Everyone can opt out at any time. We never buy or share phone number lists.
- Leads are recorded in the CRM with source, date and consent (MEZ-PLN-002).

10. Marketing KPIs

KPI	How it is measured	Target (assumed)	Review
Reach and followers	Instagram and Facebook insights	+5% followers per month	Monthly
Engagement	Likes, comments, saves, shares divided by reach	At least 4%	Monthly
Leads	Enquiries logged in the CRM	120 per month	Weekly
Lead response time	Time from enquiry to first reply	Within 2 hours during opening hours	Weekly
Conversion	Leads that become members or bookings	15%	Monthly
Cost per lead	Ad spend divided by leads	Below Rs. 400	Monthly
Event attendance	Seats filled out of seats available	75%	Per event
Member retention	Members who renew next month	70%	Monthly
Review rating	Average Google rating and sentiment of reviews	Aim for 4.5 or above, based on real reviews only	Monthly
Complaints about marketing	Complaints about misleading content or offers	Zero	Monthly

The Marketing Executive prepares a one-page KPI report by the 5th of each month for the HR / Sales / Marketing Manager and CEO. Targets are reviewed each quarter. Numbers are reported honestly, even when they are low.

11. Testimonials, Reviews and Photo Permissions

Item	Rule
Written consent	Before using a guest's name, words, photo or video, we get her written or recorded consent (Annex C). She says where it can be used and for how long.
Real words only	Testimonials must be real. We may fix spelling, but not the meaning. We never invent guests, quotes or ratings.
Sample content	If placeholder or sample quotes are shown, for example on a student project website, they are clearly marked as samples.
No pressure or payment	We do not pay for positive reviews, ask staff to write reviews, or tell guests what to say. A thank-you chai is fine only after the review is posted, and cannot depend on a good rating.
Children	Photos of children need written consent from a parent or guardian and are never posted with names or locations.
Withdrawing consent	A guest can withdraw consent at any time. We remove the content from our channels within 7 days and tell her when it is done.
Event photos	We tell guests at the entrance when photos are taken. A photo-free zone and badge are offered. No cameras in washrooms or the prayer area.

Item	Rule
Records	Consent forms are filed and kept as long as the content is used, plus 1 year.

12. Truthful Advertising Claims

Rule	What it means
True and provable	Every claim about food, prices, safety, service or results must be true, and we can show evidence on request.
No fake claims	We do not claim awards, ratings, rankings, years in business, celebrity visits or number of members unless true and documented.
Clear offers	State what is included, any limit and when it ends. “Free” means free.
Honest food claims	We do not say “healthy”, “organic”, “halal-certified” or “sugar-free” without proof. Allergens are listed truthfully.
Honest safety claims	We can say “women-only” and “photos only with consent” because we follow them. We never promise absolute security.
Honest workshops	Describe what participants will learn and who teaches. No promises of income or jobs.
Fair comparisons	Compare only on facts and never attack other businesses.

Claim check: before publishing, the creator writes each factual claim and its evidence on the campaign form (Annex B). The HR / Sales / Marketing Manager signs it. If there is no evidence, the claim is removed.

13. Brand Reputation Monitoring and Response

13.1 Monitoring

- The Marketing Executive checks Instagram, Facebook, WhatsApp Business, Google reviews and tags twice a day during opening days, and sets alerts for the brand name.
- Every comment, review or mention needing action is logged in the Reputation Response Log (Annex E).

13.2 Response times and approach

Type	Response time (assumed)	Approach
Question or praise	Within 4 hours	Thank warmly. Answer clearly.
Mild complaint or negative review	Within 24 hours	Thank her, apologise if we are at fault, offer to fix privately. Share a contact. Never argue in public.
Serious complaint (safety, privacy, harassment, food illness)	Within 2 hours, and escalate at once	Stay calm and kind. Move to a private conversation. Follow MEZ-SOP-002 and MEZ-SOP-008.
False or abusive post	Within 24 hours	Reply once politely with facts. Report to the platform if it breaks the rules. Keep a record.

Type	Response time (assumed)	Approach
Media or influencer question	Same day	Do not answer alone. Pass to the HR / Sales / Marketing Manager.

13.3 Escalation and crisis

1. The Marketing Executive informs the HR / Sales / Marketing Manager, who informs the CEO within 2 hours for a serious issue.
2. The CEO decides on a public statement. Only the CEO, Owner or a person named by them speaks publicly.
3. The statement is honest, short, caring and avoids blame. Corrections are quick and clear.
4. Paid ads and scheduled posts are paused if they could seem insensitive during an incident.
5. After the issue, the team reviews what happened and records corrective actions (see CAPA in MEZ-SOP-010).

Reviews are never deleted or hidden, except those that break platform rules.

14. Compliance, Review and Approval

14.1 Training and acknowledgement

- Staff who create or share content attend a brand and privacy briefing in their first month and sign an acknowledgement. A refresher is held every year.

14.2 Compliance checks

Check	Frequency	Responsible
Posts compared with claims, privacy and brand rules	Monthly	HR / Sales / Marketing Manager
Consent forms match published photos and testimonials	Quarterly	Documentation & Compliance Coordinator
Campaign results and spending compared with plans	Monthly	Finance Director and Marketing Executive
Social media access and two-step verification	Quarterly	IT Manager
Reputation Response Log reviewed, actions closed	Monthly	HR / Sales / Marketing Manager
Full review of these guidelines	Yearly	CEO and Owner

14.3 Approval

Role	Name	Signature	Date
Prepared by: HR / Sales / Marketing Manager			
Reviewed by: Finance Director			

Role	Name	Signature	Date
Approved by: CEO			
Approved by: Owner			

Annex A. Monthly Content Calendar (MEZ-FRM-043)

Month: _____ Prepared by: _____ Approved by: _____

Date	Channel	Theme and caption idea	Visual	Approved / Posted

Annex B. Campaign Plan and Claim Check (MEZ-FRM-044)

Field	Details
Campaign name and dates	
Goal and KPI target	
Audience	
Main message and offer (with conditions)	
Channels and content needed	
Budget (PKR) and approval	
Factual claims and evidence for each	
Privacy and consent checks done?	
Risks and how to handle them	
Prepared by, approved by and date	
Results and lessons (after the campaign)	

Annex C. Testimonial and Photo Consent Form (MEZ-FRM-045)

Field	Details
Guest name (or first name only)	
Contact (phone or email)	
Content (quote, photo or video) described	
Where it may be used (website, Instagram, print)	
Use period	
Name shown? (full name / first name / anonymous)	
Parent or guardian name (if a child is shown)	

Field	Details
I understand I can withdraw consent at any time	
Signature and date	
Staff member and date received	

Annex D. Pre-Publication Checklist (MEZ-FRM-046)

Check	Done (date and initials)
Facts, prices and dates are correct	
Every claim has evidence	
Consent exists for every person shown	
No private areas or private details visible	
Colours, fonts and logo follow the guidelines	
Spelling checked in English and Urdu	
Tone is warm, respectful and honest	
Second person approved the post	
Scheduled by and date	

Annex E. Reputation Response Log (MEZ-FRM-047)

Date and channel	Comment or review (summary)	Type and priority	Response and by whom	Closed (date)